# AIXA.DE - Aixtron SE

Framework 8 evidence review | Engineering reviewed: 6 October 2026 | Preliminary earnings update: 16 October 2026

**Status:** Full retained research and operating model, updated for the issuer's October 15 preliminary Q3 results. The full statement is due October 29; evidence qualifications remain active.

**Classification:** COMPOUND-SEMICONDUCTOR EQUIPMENT BOTTLENECK - deposition capacity and customer acceptance

**Current Excel Base: 83/100.** Analytical recommendation: **83/100 (50/60)**, advisory only.

**Active Q4 2027 operating ceiling: EUR 100 per share.** The later Q1 2028 ceiling remains EUR 108; the active-horizon label does not change the forecast. Financial amounts: EUR millions; margins derived where applicable. Ceilings: EUR per share.

The ceiling is one conditional operating case. Probability is not multiplied into revenue, operating profit or the ceiling. Portfolio Base and the analytical category score are distinct; the latter does not overwrite the former.

## Preliminary results: better Q3 conversion, unchanged annual case

AIXTRON reported preliminary Q3 revenue of about EUR 184 million, gross profit of about EUR 87 million and EBIT of about EUR 57 million. Orders were about EUR 275 million. Management linked the stronger profitability to product mix and the order momentum to laser equipment for AI data-center communications. These are preliminary group amounts, not finalized product results or accepted future orders.

The full-year revenue and profit controls remain unchanged. Higher Q3 profit is offset by a lower Q4 model residual; it is not extrapolated automatically into 2027. The Q4 2026 forward-four-quarter target moves from about EUR 63 to EUR 61, about -3%, because that window excludes the stronger Q3 quarter. The Q3 2026 window includes both quarters and is unchanged. The active Q4 2027 target remains about EUR 100.

The EUR 87 million gross profit divided by EUR 184 million revenue implies about 47% gross margin; the issuer describes gross margin as approximately 48%. Both are rounded preliminary disclosures. We retain the disclosed amounts and flag that difference for the October 29 statement rather than forcing a different gross-profit number. The issuer's approximately 31% EBIT margin is consistent with its reported amounts.

The current Excel Base and analytical Base are both 83. The older artifact's Excel Base wording is corrected to the current saved workbook value; no Base change is made or claimed. Published values are whole-number approximations for reading. The linked model and calculation file retain exact values, conversion terms and shares.

# 1. Thesis, products and competitive position

## Deposition is upstream of the optical device

AIXTRON supplies deposition equipment used to grow compound-semiconductor layers. Its optoelectronic, GaN, SiC, LED/research and after-sales exposure spans different customer investment cycles. InP-related laser demand can tighten a qualified process or tool supply chain while power-device customers are still absorbing prior investment.

The original G10 platform map links AsP equipment to relevant optoelectronics, GaN to power/RF applications and SiC to power devices. CW, EML and DFB lasers, EV/grid devices, microLED and other applications have different process requirements. Neither every compound semiconductor nor every InP laser is necessarily produced using AIXTRON equipment; Veeco, AMEC and alternative deposition routes require product-specific competitive analysis.

## Turning device demand into equipment revenue

A photonics systems TAM is not a deposition-equipment TAM. A defensible bridge needs device demand, wafer output, usable reactor throughput, customer installed capacity, equipment allocation, ASP and acceptance timing. Tool delivery creates potential capacity; customer installation and qualification determine when that capacity produces saleable devices. The original 12-18 month lag is a planning observation, not a universal schedule.

The current optoelectronic order inflection is therefore a useful leading indicator for laser suppliers, subject to who placed the order and which process is being expanded. GaN/SiC power, microLED, LiDAR, defense and quantum-related applications broaden the technological opportunity without guaranteeing simultaneous revenue ramps. The five-vector model and current convertible denominator below are the sole numerical operating case.

Research provenance: the product and competitive analysis in this section synthesizes the supplied original research. Dated market-share, process and channel claims retain their original evidence status; this integration is not a new independent verification of those claims. Current earnings and model assumptions are set out below.

## Named optical orders connect the tool thesis to a customer

The March article links laser-capacity investment to epitaxy equipment. A stronger later source names the customer: on May 19 AIXTRON disclosed multiple **Lumentum G10-AsP orders** for InP optical production. The platform supports 6-inch processing and manufacturing controls intended to improve repeatability and handling. This confirms a commercial equipment relationship; the release does not disclose reactor count, contract value or customer-acceptance dates. AIXTRON's Lumentum release.

The conversion chain is customer device demand, required good epitaxial wafers, installed reactor throughput, tool orders, delivery and acceptance. A 6-inch wafer or new reactor does not by itself establish qualified good-laser output: recipe uniformity, defect density, wafer handling, process cycle time and device qualification determine the saleable result. NVIDIA funding received by optical customers is not automatically spent on AIXTRON tools, and customer laser sales cannot be counted again as equipment sales.

**Probability and model treatment:** assign an 85% research probability that some of the announced tools are accepted by the end of 2027. The conditional amount is undisclosed. The active model already assumes optical MOCVD revenue of **€780 million in 2027 and EUR 1,120 million in 2028**, with 49% gross margin. We allocate the named order evidence inside that existing customer-expansion thesis (100% overlap for this

review), retaining a zero additional revenue/OP increment. This is an analytical inclusion judgment rather than a quantified customer-order reconciliation. The inherited optical gross profit is €382 million/€549 million before common opex; delivery, installation, service and manufacturing costs remain in the current margins and expense schedule. No new pricing premium is inferred from the funding headline or product launch.

**Bounded allocation check:** to test the size of the opportunity without inventing a reactor count or selling price, use a 5-10% slice of the existing 2027 optical-revenue pool. This is an analyst-selected sensitivity range, not an estimate of Lumentum's undisclosed contract value or share. It gives €39-78 million conditional revenue, or €33-66 million at the 85% timing weight. Apply the existing 49% optical gross margin and use the existing 2027 company opex/revenue ratio of 16% only as a transparent allocation proxy. The resulting weighted OP attribution is €11-22 million before overlap. Assigning that slice entirely inside the already forecast optical ramp removes it from the incremental column. It leaves zero additional revenue, cost, OP or valuation. A true customer-level allocation may differ; delivered reactors, acceptance dates and net contract prices would replace this diagnostic.

| 2027 sensitivity, EUR M unless stated | Low slice | High slice |
|---|---|---|
| Share of existing €780 million optical pool | 5% | 10% |
| Conditional revenue attribution | 39 | 78 |
| Timing probability | 85% | 85% |
| Weighted revenue attribution | 33 | 66 |
| COGS attribution, 51% | 17 | 34 |
| Gross profit attribution, 49% | 16 | 32 |
| Opex allocation proxy, 16% | 5 | 11 |
| Operating profit attribution | 11 | 22 |
| Overlap with existing optical forecast | 100% | 100% |
| Net incremental revenue and OP | 0 | 0 |

This evidence supports the optical vector while leaving GaN/SiC customer cycles separate. Reactor count, order value, acceptance dates and qualified throughput are the remaining bridge gaps. The existing **25x OP** basis, exact economic diluted-share denominator, analytical Base 83 and current Excel Base 83 remain unchanged. The old artifact's Base text was stale; this update does not change the actual Excel Base. Active Q4 2027 target remains **€100**; the later Q1 2028 target remains **€108**.

# 2. Earnings, guidance and operating assumptions

## Preliminary Q3 results and retained guidance

H1 actual revenue EUR 175 million, gross profit EUR 58 million and EBIT negative EUR 8 million. Q2 orders were EUR 215 million; equipment backlog was EUR 457 million. Customer advances support production funding. Latest financial source.

FY2026 guidance remains revenue EUR 560 million plus or minus EUR 30 million, gross margin about 42% and EBIT margin 17-20%. Q3 preliminary group revenue 184, gross profit 87 and EBIT 57 replace the old forecast. The retained full-year midpoint implies Q4 model revenue 202, gross profit 91, operating expense 36 and EBIT 54. Q4 is an ASTRA residual, not new issuer quarterly guidance. Full-year gross profit 235, H2 operating expense 66 and full-year EBIT 104 are unchanged. All 2027-and-later operating assumptions are retained.

## Model and evidence

The EUR 275 million order intake is not added directly to sales or backlog without the issuer reconciliation. Favorable Q3 mix does not establish a permanent 31% EBIT margin, new reactor pricing or an incremental optical sales tranche. Existing optical ramp, customer qualification, manufacturing/support costs and financing assumptions remain unchanged.

## Retained annual controls and the Q4 residual

| EUR millions | H1 actual | Q3 preliminary | Q4 residual | Full year |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Revenue | 175 | 184 | 202 | 560 |
| Gross profit | 58 | 87 | 91 | 235 |
| Operating profit | -8 | 57 | 54 | 104 |

Rounded columns can differ from the displayed annual total. Exact controls reconcile in the saved model. H2 opex remains about EUR 66 million, allocated about EUR 30 million to Q3 andEUR 36 million to Q4.

Five product vectors distinguish optical MOCVD, power, LED, research tools and after-sales. Q3 preliminary group totals are reported; its five-vector split is a LOW-confidence imputation. Q4 is a guidance residual with an imputed split. The allocation scales each old product revenue proportionately and shifts product margins together to reconcile group gross profit. No product split or margin is presented as reported. The H2 gross-profit bridge equals full-year revenue times 42% less H1 gross profit. Quarterly product GMs allocate that guide; they are not disclosed GMs. H2 opex of EUR 66 million yields full-year EBIT within guidance. Beyond 2026 optical production ramps and a slower power recovery are LOW-confidence assumptions. The exact retained economic-share denominator assumes full initial-price conversion of the existing bond, without treating conversion as completed. Exact conversion terms remain in the model and source record.

Preliminary group amounts remain approximate until the October 29 statement. HIGH denotes the source status of disclosed amounts or guidance, not certainty about a future outcome or a reported product split. MEDIUM denotes sourced extrapolation. Forward product splits, margins, recognition schedules and long-term growth not specifically guided are LOW confidence.

# 3. Analytical score

The category arithmetic gives **50/60 = 83/100** after the existing -3-point risk deduction. The portfolio Base remains **83/100**. Risk-class detail appears in section 7.

| Category | Points | Maximum | Evidence |
|---|---|---|---|
| Core thesis | 18 | 20 | Compound-semiconductor deposition tools sit upstream of optical production. The current demand inflection is optoelectronics; weak SiC/GaN power-equipment demand cannot be assumed to recover at the same pace. |
| Cycle stage | 9 | 10 | Latest reported conversion and management timing; forecasting risk is scored separately. |
| TAM expansion | 9 | 10 | Addressable products and expansion discussed in the industry section; overlapping pools are not added. |
| Catalysts | 5 | 5 | Next earnings, qualification, delivery and capacity milestones. |
| Macro | 9 | 10 | AI infrastructure demand supports the cycle; customer spending is not guaranteed supplier revenue. |
| Alpha | 3 | 5 | Differentiation comes from product, accounting and recognition analysis, not price performance. |
| Risk penalty | -3 | 0 | Active financing, execution, competitive and accounting/model risks listed below. |

# 4. Product economics and quarterly operating model

Forecasts distinguish reported anchors from guidance and analyst assumptions. Where the model uses segment OP or an adjusted profit proxy rather than product GP less opex, the stated basis applies; do not treat those proxies as a newly disclosed GAAP decomposition.

## Quarterly revenue and operating profit

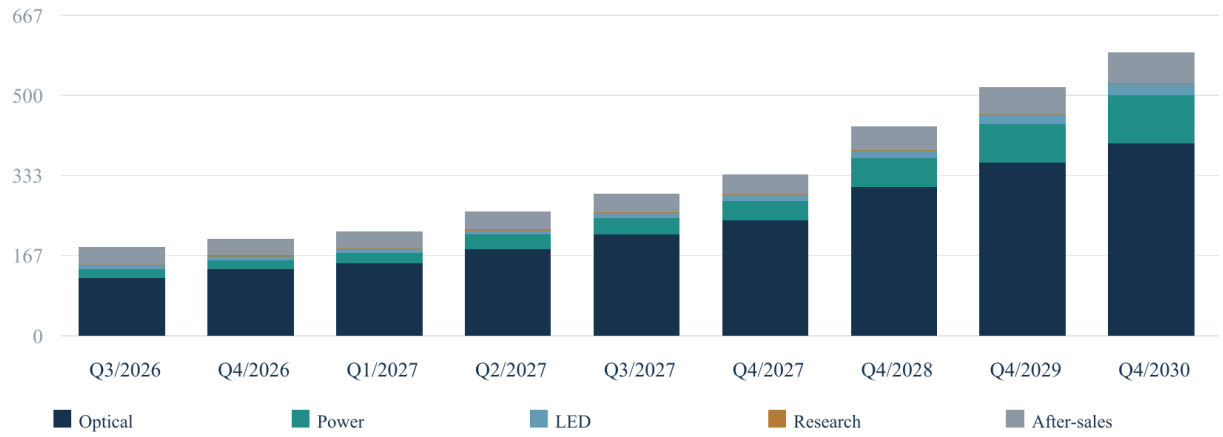
Amounts in EUR millions; margins derived where applicable. Shares are in millions, using the economic denominator shown below. A positive deduction reduces profit.

| Quarter | Status | Revenue | Gross profit | Opex | OP | OP margin |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q3 2026 | Preliminary | 184 | 87 | 30 | 57 | 31% |
| Q4 2026 | FY residual | 202 | 91 | 36 | 54 | 27% |
| Q1 2027 | Forecast | 217 | 104 | 35 | 69 | 32% |
| Q2 2027 | Forecast | 258 | 123 | 41 | 82 | 32% |
| Q3 2027 | Forecast | 296 | 141 | 47 | 94 | 32% |
| Q4 2027 | Forecast | 336 | 160 | 54 | 106 | 32% |
| Q1 2028 | Forecast | 352 | 167 | 49 | 118 | 33% |
| Q2 2028 | Forecast | 380 | 180 | 53 | 127 | 33% |
| Q3 2028 | Forecast | 408 | 193 | 57 | 136 | 33% |
| Q4 2028 | Forecast | 436 | 206 | 61 | 145 | 33% |
| Q1 2029 | Forecast | 459 | 214 | 64 | 149 | 33% |
| Q2 2029 | Forecast | 482 | 224 | 67 | 157 | 33% |
| Q3 2029 | Forecast | 500 | 232 | 70 | 162 | 32% |
| Q4 2029 | Forecast | 518 | 240 | 73 | 168 | 32% |
| Q1 2030 | Forecast | 536 | 248 | 75 | 173 | 32% |
| Q2 2030 | Forecast | 554 | 256 | 78 | 179 | 32% |
| Q3 2030 | Forecast | 572 | 265 | 80 | 184 | 32% |
| Q4 2030 | Forecast | 590 | 273 | 83 | 190 | 32% |

## Financial view 1. Revenue and mix

### Revenue and five analytical product vectors

EUR millions. Q3 group total is preliminary; product split is imputed.




Updated five-vector revenue chart. EUR millions; Q3 group total is preliminary and product mix is imputed.

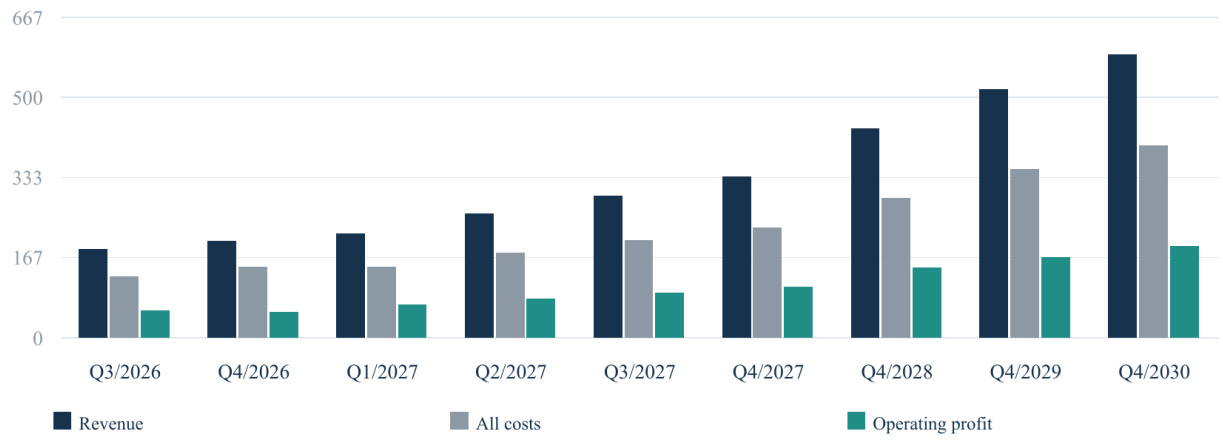
Source: updated approved AIXA_DE_Q_Model. Q3 group totals are preliminary reported; the product allocation remains imputed. Q4 is a full-year-guidance residual. Other future rows remain Model / LOW forecast confidence.

| Quarter | Optical | Power | LED | Research | After-sales | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q3 2026 | 120 | 18 | 8 | 2 | 36 | 184 |
| Q4 2026 | 138 | 20 | 8 | 2 | 34 | 202 |
| Q1 2027 | 150 | 22 | 8 | 2 | 35 | 217 |
| Q2 2027 | 180 | 30 | 9 | 2 | 37 | 258 |
| Q3 2027 | 210 | 35 | 10 | 2 | 39 | 296 |
| Q4 2027 | 240 | 40 | 12 | 2 | 42 | 336 |
| Q1 2028 | 250 | 45 | 12 | 2 | 43 | 352 |
| Q2 2028 | 270 | 50 | 13 | 2 | 45 | 380 |
| Q3 2028 | 290 | 55 | 14 | 2 | 47 | 408 |
| Q4 2028 | 310 | 60 | 15 | 2 | 49 | 436 |
| Q1 2029 | 325 | 65 | 16 | 2 | 51 | 459 |
| Q2 2029 | 340 | 70 | 17 | 2 | 53 | 482 |
| Q3 2029 | 350 | 75 | 18 | 2 | 55 | 500 |
| Q4 2029 | 360 | 80 | 19 | 2 | 57 | 518 |
| Q1 2030 | 370 | 85 | 20 | 2 | 59 | 536 |
| Q2 2030 | 380 | 90 | 21 | 2 | 61 | 554 |
| Q3 2030 | 390 | 95 | 22 | 2 | 63 | 572 |
| Q4 2030 | 400 | 100 | 23 | 2 | 65 | 590 |

## Financial view 2. Margins, costs and profit

### Quarterly revenue, costs and operating profit

EUR millions. All costs = manufacturing cost plus operating expense.




Updated quarterly revenue, manufacturing and operating costs, and operating profit. EUR millions.

Q3 group totals are preliminary reported; Q4 is a model residual. Later rows remain Model / LOW forecast confidence. Total operating costs mean cost of goods plus operating expenses. Gross profit less the existing operating-cost deduction reconciles exactly to operating profit.

| Quarter | Revenue | GP | Opex | OP | OP margin | All costs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q3 2026 | 184 | 87 | 30 | 57 | 31% | 127 |
| Q4 2026 | 202 | 91 | 36 | 54 | 27% | 147 |
| Q1 2027 | 217 | 104 | 35 | 69 | 32% | 148 |
| Q2 2027 | 258 | 123 | 41 | 82 | 32% | 176 |
| Q3 2027 | 296 | 141 | 47 | 94 | 32% | 202 |
| Q4 2027 | 336 | 160 | 54 | 106 | 32% | 230 |
| Q1 2028 | 352 | 167 | 49 | 118 | 33% | 234 |
| Q2 2028 | 380 | 180 | 53 | 127 | 33% | 253 |
| Q3 2028 | 408 | 193 | 57 | 136 | 33% | 272 |
| Q4 2028 | 436 | 206 | 61 | 145 | 33% | 291 |
| Q1 2029 | 459 | 214 | 64 | 149 | 33% | 310 |
| Q2 2029 | 482 | 224 | 67 | 157 | 33% | 325 |
| Q3 2029 | 500 | 232 | 70 | 162 | 32% | 338 |
| Q4 2029 | 518 | 240 | 73 | 168 | 32% | 350 |
| Q1 2030 | 536 | 248 | 75 | 173 | 32% | 363 |
| Q2 2030 | 554 | 256 | 78 | 179 | 32% | 375 |
| Q3 2030 | 572 | 265 | 80 | 184 | 32% | 388 |
| Q4 2030 | 590 | 273 | 83 | 190 | 32% | 400 |

## Product/segment inputs

Margin basis: Gross margin. Revenue x the listed margin gives the product/segment contribution; sum contributions and subtract the deduction above to obtain OP. Product inputs are model estimates unless identified as reported. Source anchors and guidance are cited below; future inputs also retain the sanctioned workbook assumptions where separately identified as model assumptions.

### Optoelectronic MOCVD

| Quarter | Revenue | Assumed GM | GP contribution |
|---|---|---|---|
| Q3 2026 | 120 | 49% | 59 |
| Q4 2026 | 138 | 47% | 65 |
| Q1 2027 | 150 | 49% | 74 |
| Q2 2027 | 180 | 49% | 88 |
| Q3 2027 | 210 | 49% | 103 |
| Q4 2027 | 240 | 49% | 118 |
| Q1 2028 | 250 | 49% | 123 |
| Q2 2028 | 270 | 49% | 132 |
| Q3 2028 | 290 | 49% | 142 |
| Q4 2028 | 310 | 49% | 152 |
| Q1 2029 | 325 | 48% | 156 |
| Q2 2029 | 340 | 48% | 163 |
| Q3 2029 | 350 | 48% | 168 |
| Q4 2029 | 360 | 48% | 173 |
| Q1 2030 | 370 | 48% | 178 |
| Q2 2030 | 380 | 48% | 182 |
| Q3 2030 | 390 | 48% | 187 |
| Q4 2030 | 400 | 48% | 192 |

## GaN and SiC power

| Quarter | Revenue | Assumed GM | GP contribution |
|---|---|---|---|
| Q3 2026 | 18 | 32% | 6 |
| Q4 2026 | 20 | 28% | 6 |
| Q1 2027 | 22 | 37% | 8 |
| Q2 2027 | 30 | 37% | 11 |
| Q3 2027 | 35 | 37% | 13 |
| Q4 2027 | 40 | 37% | 15 |
| Q1 2028 | 45 | 37% | 17 |
| Q2 2028 | 50 | 37% | 19 |
| Q3 2028 | 55 | 37% | 20 |
| Q4 2028 | 60 | 37% | 22 |
| Q1 2029 | 65 | 37% | 24 |
| Q2 2029 | 70 | 37% | 26 |
| Q3 2029 | 75 | 37% | 28 |
| Q4 2029 | 80 | 37% | 30 |
| Q1 2030 | 85 | 37% | 31 |
| Q2 2030 | 90 | 37% | 33 |
| Q3 2030 | 95 | 37% | 35 |
| Q4 2030 | 100 | 37% | 37 |

## LED and microLED

| Quarter | Revenue | Assumed GM | GP contribution |
|---|---|---|---|
| Q3 2026 | 8 | 32% | 3 |
| Q4 2026 | 8 | 28% | 2 |
| Q1 2027 | 8 | 35% | 3 |
| Q2 2027 | 9 | 35% | 3 |
| Q3 2027 | 10 | 35% | 4 |
| Q4 2027 | 12 | 35% | 4 |
| Q1 2028 | 12 | 35% | 4 |
| Q2 2028 | 13 | 35% | 5 |
| Q3 2028 | 14 | 35% | 5 |
| Q4 2028 | 15 | 35% | 5 |
| Q1 2029 | 16 | 35% | 6 |
| Q2 2029 | 17 | 35% | 6 |
| Q3 2029 | 18 | 35% | 6 |
| Q4 2029 | 19 | 35% | 7 |
| Q1 2030 | 20 | 35% | 7 |
| Q2 2030 | 21 | 35% | 7 |
| Q3 2030 | 22 | 35% | 8 |
| Q4 2030 | 23 | 35% | 8 |

## Research tools

| Quarter | Revenue | Assumed GM | GP contribution |
|---|---|---|---|
| Q3 2026 | 2 | 27% | <1 |
| Q4 2026 | 2 | 23% | <1 |
| Q1 2027 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q2 2027 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q3 2027 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q4 2027 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q1 2028 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q2 2028 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q3 2028 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q4 2028 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q1 2029 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q2 2029 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q3 2029 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q4 2029 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q1 2030 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q2 2030 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q3 2030 | 2 | 25% | <1 |
| Q4 2030 | 2 | 25% | <1 |

### After sales

| Quarter | Revenue | Assumed GM | GP contribution |
|---|---|---|---|
| Q3 2026 | 36 | 54% | 19 |
| Q4 2026 | 34 | 50% | 17 |
| Q1 2027 | 35 | 54% | 19 |
| Q2 2027 | 37 | 54% | 20 |
| Q3 2027 | 39 | 54% | 21 |
| Q4 2027 | 42 | 54% | 23 |
| Q1 2028 | 43 | 54% | 23 |
| Q2 2028 | 45 | 54% | 24 |
| Q3 2028 | 47 | 54% | 25 |
| Q4 2028 | 49 | 54% | 26 |
| Q1 2029 | 51 | 54% | 28 |
| Q2 2029 | 53 | 54% | 29 |
| Q3 2029 | 55 | 54% | 30 |
| Q4 2029 | 57 | 54% | 31 |
| Q1 2030 | 59 | 54% | 32 |
| Q2 2030 | 61 | 54% | 33 |
| Q3 2030 | 63 | 54% | 34 |
| Q4 2030 | 65 | 54% | 35 |

## Annual trajectory cross-check

| Year | Status | Revenue | Operating profit |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2026 | Retained FY control | 560 | 104 |
| 2027 | Forecast | 1,107 | 350 |
| 2028 | Forecast | 1,576 | 526 |
| 2029 | Forecast | 1,959 | 636 |
| 2030 | Forecast | 2,252 | 727 |

These annual sums are cross-checks, not separate valuation endpoints. Fiscal-year companies retain their fiscal labels in the quarterly table.

# 5. Forward four-quarter operating ceiling

Ceiling = sum of OP in the stated quarter and next three quarters x multiple x attribution factor x unit conversion ÷ economic diluted shares.

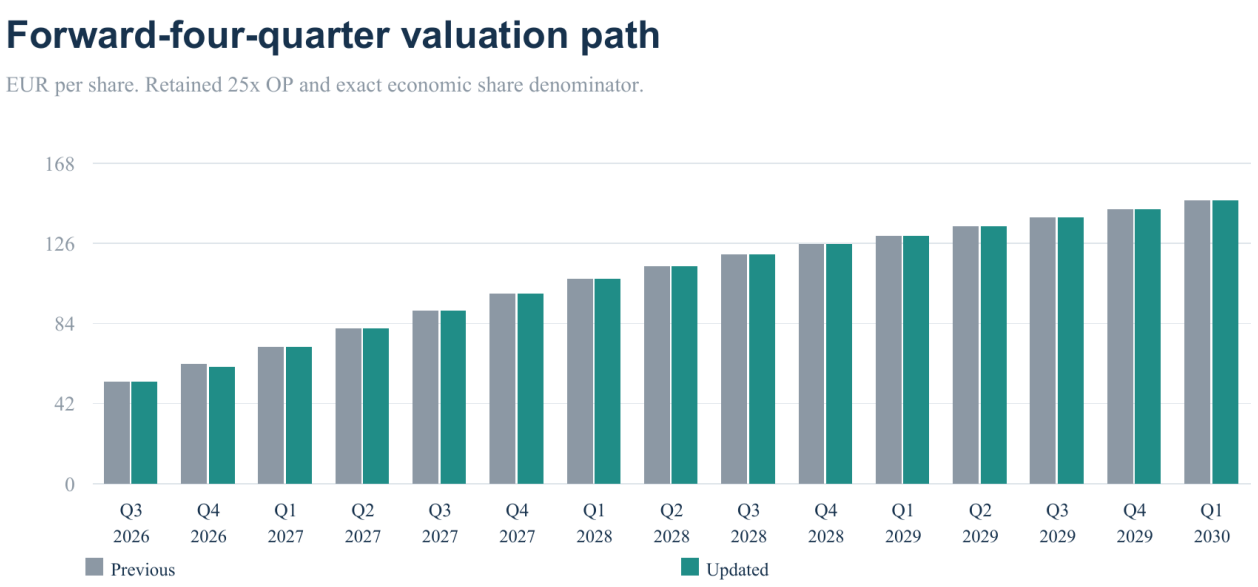
| Quarter | Window end | F4 Q OP | Multiple | Shares, M | Ceiling |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q3 2026 | Q2 2027 | 262 | 25x | 122 | 54 |
| Q4 2026 | Q3 2027 | 299 | 25x | 122 | 61 |
| Q1 2027 | Q4 2027 | 350 | 25x | 122 | 72 |
| Q2 2027 | Q1 2028 | 399 | 25x | 122 | 82 |
| Q3 2027 | Q2 2028 | 444 | 25x | 122 | 91 |
| Q4 2027 | Q3 2028 | 487 | 25x | 122 | 100 |
| Q1 2028 | Q4 2028 | 526 | 25x | 122 | 108 |
| Q2 2028 | Q1 2029 | 558 | 25x | 122 | 114 |
| Q3 2028 | Q2 2029 | 588 | 25x | 122 | 120 |
| Q4 2028 | Q3 2029 | 614 | 25x | 122 | 126 |
| Q1 2029 | Q4 2029 | 636 | 25x | 122 | 130 |
| Q2 2029 | Q1 2030 | 660 | 25x | 122 | 135 |
| Q3 2029 | Q2 2030 | 682 | 25x | 122 | 140 |
| Q4 2029 | Q3 2030 | 705 | 25x | 122 | 144 |
| Q1 2030 | Q4 2030 | 727 | 25x | 122 | 149 |

Q1 2028 retains the same four-quarter OP, 25x multiple and exact economic share denominator. Full precision remains in the model; whole-number presentation is not used to recalculate targets.

## Share sensitivity, same operating case

| Denominator change | Q1 2028 ceiling |
|---|---|
| No change | 108 |
| 5% more shares | 103 |
| 10% more shares | 98 |

## Financial view 3. Complete retained valuation path

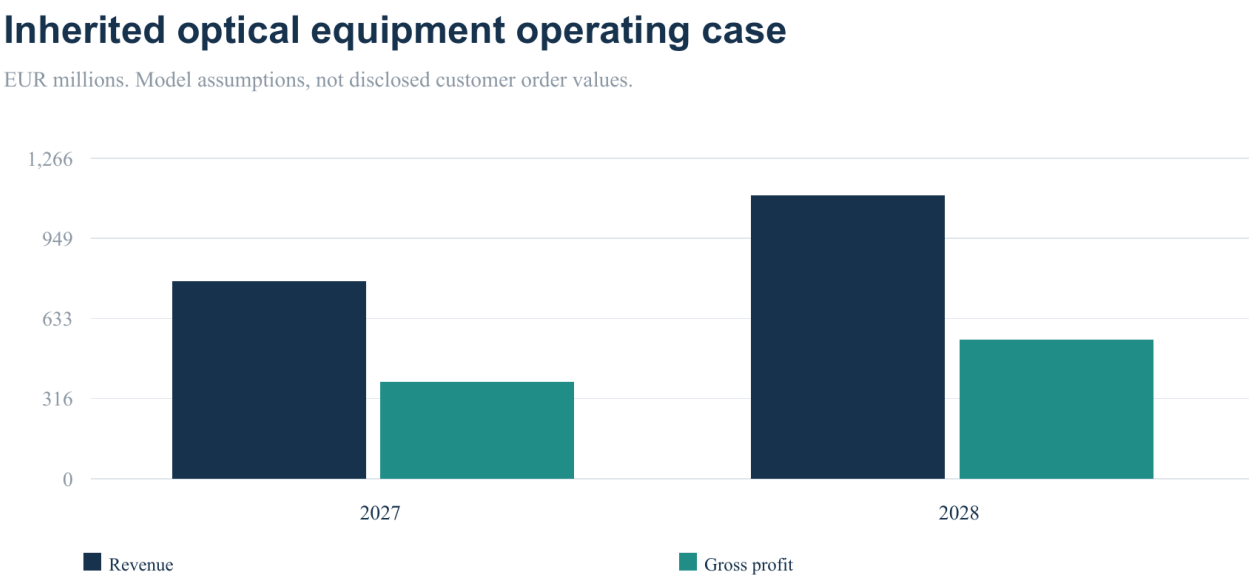



Updated 15-quarter ceiling path, EUR per share. Only the Q4 2026 window changes.

The active horizon is Q4 2027. The first quarter in each row plus the following three quarters forms the window. Shares are millions; profit is EUR M. Multiple, share path and probability/attribution factor are unchanged.

| Quarter | Previous | Updated | Revision |
|---|---|---|---|
| Q3 2026 | 54 | 54 | Unchanged |
| Q4 2026 | 63 | 61 | -3% |
| Q1 2027 | 72 | 72 | Unchanged |
| Q2 2027 | 82 | 82 | Unchanged |
| Q3 2027 | 91 | 91 | Unchanged |
| Q4 2027 | 100 | 100 | Unchanged |
| Q1 2028 | 108 | 108 | Unchanged |
| Q2 2028 | 114 | 114 | Unchanged |
| Q3 2028 | 120 | 120 | Unchanged |
| Q4 2028 | 126 | 126 | Unchanged |
| Q1 2029 | 130 | 130 | Unchanged |
| Q2 2029 | 135 | 135 | Unchanged |
| Q3 2029 | 140 | 140 | Unchanged |
| Q4 2029 | 144 | 144 | Unchanged |
| Q1 2030 | 149 | 149 | Unchanged |

## Financial view 4. Optical equipment conversion




Retained optical forecast, EUR millions; customer-specific order values remain undisclosed.

The existing 49% optical margin yields €382 million/€549 million product gross profit for 2027/2028 before common operating expenses. Named customer orders support this inherited ramp; they do not establish an additional revenue tranche. The total company opex schedule remains €177 million/€221 million, with no unsupported customer allocation.

| Existing model | 2027 | 2028 |
|---|---|---|
| Optoelectronic revenue, EUR M | 780 | 1,120 |
| Optical GM | 49% | 49% |
| Optical GP, EUR M | 382 | 549 |
| Total company opex, EUR M | 177 | 221 |
| New increment, EUR M | 0 | 0 |

# 6. Industry relationships and read-throughs

## Industry learning and read-through

LITE and COHR capacity investment is an equipment-demand signal, not guaranteed AIXTRON revenue. Growth in 800 G / 1,600 G optics should be translated into deposition capacity and acceptance dates; tools are not interchangeable with substrates or finished lasers.

Lumentum, Coherent, Sivers and other laser/device suppliers can provide customer-capex evidence. Riber’s MBE and oxide routes are distinct from AIXTRON’s MOCVD opportunity. A new reactor is not equivalent to a substrate sale, a qualified laser shipment or an optical module sale.

# 7. Risks and falsification tests

The following ledger makes the existing aggregate risk deduction explicit. It does not introduce another deduction or change the analytical score.

| Risk class | Existing deduction |
|---|---|
| Tool delivery, customer acceptance and qualification | -1 |
| Optical-cycle normalization and power-market recovery | -1 |
| Competition, export restrictions and convertible dilution | -1 |
| **Total** | **-3** |

## Risks and next tests

1. Customer acceptance slips from the guided H2 delivery window. 2. Optical orders normalize before power markets recover. 3. Competition, export rules and convertible dilution constrain captured value.

On October 29 reconcile the preliminary group amounts, gross-margin rounding difference, order book, product mix, customer acceptance and full-year outlook. Change only the affected product, cost, timing or share input. The current review does not resolve the retained evidence gaps or establish a new 2027 growth branch.

## Numbered monitoring tests

| # | Checkpoint | Evidence supporting the operating case | Counter-test / failure signal |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | H2 conversion | Reconcile backlog to accepted deliveries and the guided full-year profit bridge. | Delivery without acceptance or a timing slip invalidates the affected quarter. |
| 2 | Capacity bridge | Translate named customer investment into reactor demand and allocation. | The full photonics TAM cannot be treated as AIXTRON equipment sales. |
| 3 | Cycle separation | Track optoelectronic orders separately from GaN/SiC recovery. | Strength in one product does not prove simultaneous recovery in another. |
| 4 | Competition and capital | Monitor process wins, export conditions and conversion terms. | A competitor qualification or different economic dilution changes captured value. |

# 8. Sources, evidence gaps and model snapshot

- Beyond 2026, product revenue and margins are LOW-confidence analyst ramps, not orders or company guidance. Customer-specific capex allocation is not disclosed; the proxy uses the company order book and recognition timing. - 113 million legacy ordinary-share assumption plus full initial-price conversion of EUR 450 million bonds is a conservative economic denominator; conversion is not assumed completed. No cash value from the bond is added.

Both latest management prepared speeches and H1 guidance checked. Full Q&A transcripts are not reconciled.

Sources below retain the earlier research and earnings-review provenance, supplemented by the October 15 preliminary issuer announcement. LOW-confidence product allocations, future margins, capacity bridges and incomplete management-call records remain unresolved where stated. Integrating the original research does not resolve the explicitly retained evidentiary gaps.

- 2026-10-15: Preliminary Q3 order intake and operating profitability. Disclosed amounts are approximate; full statement scheduled October 29. The original issuer page is retained locally with its verified SHA256.

- 2026-07-30: H1 earnings and outlook. - 2026-07-30: H1 management prepared remarks. - 2026-04-30: Q1 management prepared remarks. - 2026-04-15: Convertible terms. - Numerical operating case: approved portfolio model; economic assumptions and evidence qualifications are stated in this artifact.

The unchanged original source document is retained separately for full research provenance. It is an archive, not an additional active valuation case. Superseded score/ceiling tables are not incorporated into this active artifact.

**Model snapshot:** retained portfolio case updated 16 October 2026 only for the preliminary Q3 / FY2026 timing and mix bridge; 15 ceiling endpoints from Q3 2026 through Q1 2030. Q1 2028 remains about EUR 108 per share. The active Q4 2027 target remains about EUR 100. Portfolio Base = 83/100. Category score = 50/60. Forecast evidence and accounting exceptions are stated above.